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RAKUTEN REWARDS, USER ACQUISITION CAMPAIGNS

Rakuten Rewards became an M&C Saatchi Performance client in 2021 during Big Give Week when participating merchants offered the greatest Cash Back and rewards of the year.

Initially, the focus was on driving incremental app installs and new member sign-ups to Rakuten Rewards through display ad placements targeting audiences with a high affinity for the app, preloads/new device activations, and custom mweb content across contextually relevant sites.

In Q3, we tested a new messaging approach leveraging micro influencers on TikTok. This was so successful, we ran a subsequent campaign in Q4 to support Rakuten during the peak holiday season, as well as promote the 'Refer a Friend' program using macro influencers across social channels.

SUMMARY OF INFLUENCER CAMPAIGNS TO DATE

1. MICRO INFLUENCERS

We worked with micro influencers on TikTok to develop native content that would appear organically in users' feed and drive organic reach initially to understand creative potential. Then, (using the most successful organic content), we amplified the results through paid media.

2. HOLIDAY SUPPORT

Given the success of the first campaign, Rakuten partnered with with micro influencers on TikTok again in Q4 during the holiday season when shopping would be at its peak.

Like the initial campaign, the objective was to get people to download the app and sign up.

3. REFER A FRIEND

For the third campaign, we partnered with macro influencers to promote the 'Refer A Friend' program. We ran on TikTok, Instagram & YouTube.

The strategy was to use influencers with at least 1MM followers and get the target audience to sign up for Rakuten using the influencer's referral link.

INITIAL CAMPAIGN APPROACH

THIS CAMPAIGN WAS REPEATED TO SUPPORT HOLIDAY SHOPPING IN Q4

THE BRIEF:

Help position Rakuten Rewards as the leading Cash Back and rewards app in the USA, driving incremental app installs and new member sign-ups.

THE CHALLENGE:

With 70% of users on iOS, Rakuten needed to identify channels that would continue to reach its core audience while still being able to measure success around iOS 14.5+ limitations.

THE STRATEGY:

We identified and partnered with 22 micro influencers on TikTok to develop content that would be posted to their channels and appear organically in users' feeds. The idea was to drive low level awareness initially to enable us to understand which content was most likely to perform effectively with paid media.

After 2 weeks, we identified the top-viewed and most engaging videos to enable the launch of a paid media campaign that was trackable on SKAdNetwork.

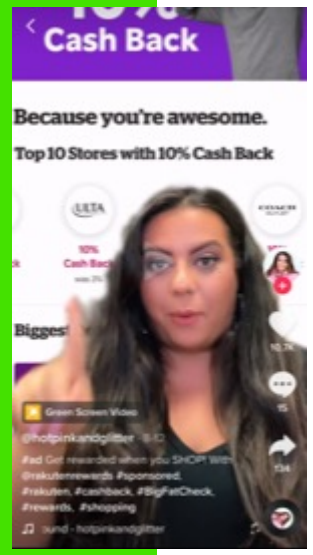
INFLUENCER EXAMPLES

During the first campaign, Rakuten partnered with 22 micro-influencers on TikTok whose native content represented key shopping categories on the app – e.g. Fashion, Beauty, Kids, Travel, etc.

The influencers were asked to download the app, log in, and scroll through stores they were interested in – showing the flow of how much Cash Back could be earned and how easy it was to use the app within the video they created.

The influencers provided recommendations in their own style which resonated with the TikTok community compared to the studio-produced creatives that the client tested previously on the platform. The best-performing organic content was then promoted using paid media to increase audience reach and allow for cleaner measurement between OS.

hotpinkandglitter



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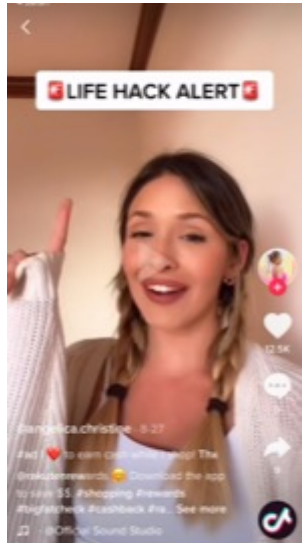

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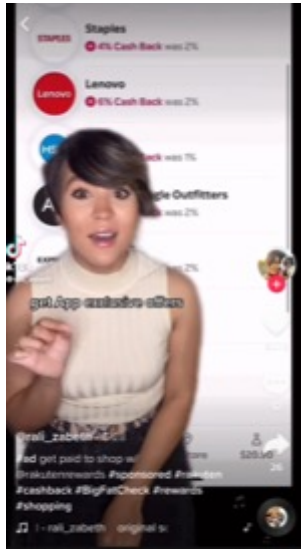

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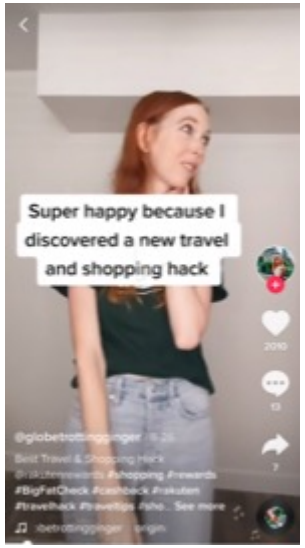

INITIAL CAMPAIGN RESULTS

Client testimonials:

”M&C Saatchi Performance are an amazing team. Fast, thorough, responsive- Thank you!” Senior Manager

“The team are great to work with! They're always forward-thinking with strategies and recommendations, keeping Rakuten's goals top of mind.” Senior Manager

80%*

LOWER COST PER INSTALL

91%*

LOWER COST PER SIGN-UP

2.5+ MILLION

ORGANIC VIEWS

These results lead Rakuten to book the second campaign that ran during Q4 2021 in order to capture holiday seasonal shopping trends and incorporate as an evergreen tactic in 2022.

* Performance is against the 4 other iOS partners that were testing SKAdNetwork. Campaign delivered against pre-iOS 14.5+ KPIs within 2 weeks of launching

Results: September - October 2021

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‘REFER A FRIEND’ EXAMPLES

We collaborated with 11 macro influencers to promote the 'Refer A Friend' program on TikTok, Instagram, and YouTube using creative concepts that were authentic to the influencer’s channel – e.g. shopping hauls, vlogs, sponsored integrations, etc.

The strategy was to use influencers with significant reach, at least 1MM followers, and encourage them to sign up for Rakuten using the influencer's referral link by offering an increased sign-up bonus, $30-40 vs the standard $10 bonus when making a qualified purchase.

By drawing attention to the RAF program, new members could welcome their friends & family to use Rakuten by sharing their own referral links and continue receiving a bonus for each new member referred.

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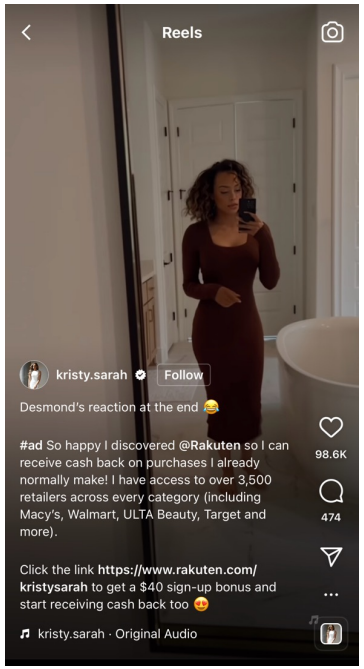
kristy.sarah



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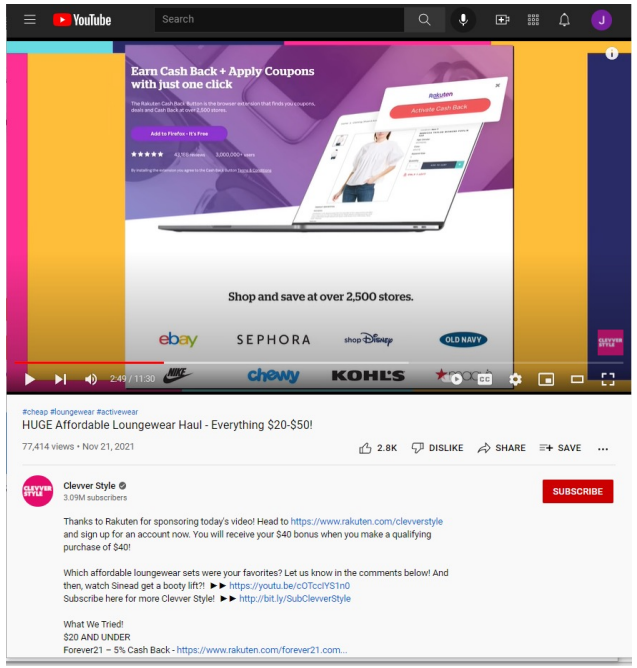

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REFER A FRIEND CAMPAIGN RESULTS

+13M

VIDEO VIEWS

$0.02

CPV

4%

ENGAGEMENT RATE

Results: November – December 2021

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TALK TO US

Contact us for more information

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